

How to use Panelist

A complete walkthrough of the placement-week scheduling console — what it is for, what every control does, and how to carry out each operation.

OPEN panelist-web-production.up.railway.app
SIGN IN coordinator / placement2026 — full access · viewer / review2026 — read only
SETUP None. The week is already scheduled when you arrive.

1 What this is for

A university placement week packs hundreds of job interviews into a few days. Every company has a shortlist of students, most students sit on several shortlists, and no student, room or interview panel can be in two places at once.

Building that timetable by hand is slow. **Keeping it valid when the day goes wrong is the real problem** — a company arrives late, an interviewer walks out, a student accepts an offer and goes home, a room floods. Every one of those breaks the plan, and a careless fix moves hundreds of appointments that did not need to move.

Panelist does three things:

Schedules	Places every shortlisted interview into a room and a time slot, guaranteeing no student, room or panel is ever double-booked.
Replans	When something goes wrong, works out a new schedule that moves as few already-booked interviews as possible.
Shows the cost	Every fix arrives as a <i>proposal</i> : how many interviews it moves, who must be told, what it leaves unplaced. Nothing changes until you approve it.

The one rule to remember. Panelist never changes the live schedule on its own. Every fix is a proposal you review and then either **Apply this fix** or **Discard**.

2 The screen at a glance

Everything lives on one screen, so the schedule never leaves your sight while you work on a fix. There are four areas.

A Top bar

Product name, the **?** help button, light/dark theme, who you are signed in as, sign out, and **Build schedule**.

B Metrics strip

Six tiles directly under the top bar: how much is scheduled, clashes, room use, student waiting time, students placed, and anything unplaced.

C Left rail

The three-step workflow — describe what happened, queue it, find a fix — plus folded panels for priority overrides, at-risk students, history and problems.

D The board

The schedule itself: day tabs, filters, and a grid of rooms across the top with time running down the side. A colour legend sits underneath.

When you ask for a fix, a fifth area — the **proposal panel** — slides in on the right. It is the only place the schedule can be changed.

3 Reading the board

Rooms run across the top, time runs down the side, and each block is one interview. Hover any block for the full detail: company, student, time, room and panel.

Block colour = the company's hiring tier

Colour is by tier rather than by company — thirty-five companies cannot each have a readable colour.

Mass recruiter	Large shortlists, low cutoffs, many panels. Usually early in the week.
Mid-size	Moderate drives.
Niche	Small headcount, high cutoffs, few panels. Usually later in the week.

Marks that appear only while you are reviewing a fix

↕ Moved	This interview would move to a different time.
× Cancelled	This interview would be cancelled. It stays visible, struck through, in its old slot so the loss is not a silent absence.
+ Added	A new interview would be placed here.

Other things on the grid

- **Lunch** — a shaded band across the board. No interview may span it.
- **Hatched cells** — that room is unavailable then; hover the room name for the reason.
- **NOW line** — a red rule marking the current moment. Everything above it has already happened and is locked: a replan can never move it.
- **Cross-hatched blocks** — interviews already under way, likewise locked.
- **Bar under each room name** — how heavily that room is used across the week. Hover for the exact figure.

4 The metrics strip

Always visible, so the health of the week is never more than a glance away. Hover any tile for a fuller explanation.

TILE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Scheduled	Share of shortlisted interviews that got a room and a slot. Green at 100%.
Clashes	Students double-booked. This must always be zero — anything else is a bug, not a trade-off.
Room use	How full the rooms are. Above about 92% there is little slack left to absorb a disruption.
Avg wait	Average gap a student spends on campus between their first and last interview of a day.
Students	How many students have at least one interview, and how many each has on average.
Unplaced	Interviews with nowhere to go. If this is above zero, open Can't be placed in the left rail for the reason.

5 The main task: fixing a disruption

This is the core workflow and it is the same three steps every time, whatever went wrong.

- 1 Say what happened. In the left rail under **What happened?** pick one of the four event types, fill in the details that appear, and press **Add this event**.
- 2 Queue everything before asking for a fix. Repeat step 1 for each thing that went wrong. They collect under **Queued**; remove any with the **×**. *Solving several problems together moves far fewer interviews than fixing them one at a time.*
- 3 Press **Replan around N changes**. The proposal panel opens on the right and the board previews every change behind it. Nothing has been committed.
- 4 Review, then decide. **Apply this fix** commits it; **Discard** throws it away and leaves the schedule untouched.

Before you replan, set two things in the **Find a fix** box. **Move limit** — the share of the week a fix may reshuffle (default 10%); go past it and the fix needs your explicit sign-off. **Time now** — how far the day has got; everything earlier is locked so a replan can never rewrite the past.

6 The four disruption types

Choose one under **What happened?**. Only the fields that matter for that event appear.

EVENT	YOU PROVIDE	USE IT WHEN
Running late	Company, day, hours late	A company arrives late. Only that morning is blocked — the rest of its week is untouched.
Panel leaves	Company, day, time it leaves	An interviewer drops out mid-week. Interviews that panel already ran are not undone.

Student out	Student ID, day, time	A student accepts an offer. Their <i>remaining interviews that day</i> are cancelled; later days stand.
Room lost	Room, day	A room becomes unusable for the day.

7 Managing the roster

Under **Or change the roster** in the same panel. These are deliberate decisions rather than accidents, but they go through exactly the same review — because adding a company means finding slots that are already taken.

Add a company

For a company that registers after the week was planned.

- 1 Pick **Add company**.
- 2 Enter the **company name**.
- 3 Set **CGPA cutoff** (minimum grade a student needs), **Shortlist** (how many students to invite), **Panels** (parallel interviews it can run), and **Minutes** (interview length).
- 4 Press **Add this change**, then **Replan around 1 change**, review and apply.

The top students meeting the cutoff are shortlisted automatically — you do not pick them by hand.

Drop a company

Pick **Drop company**, choose it from the list, add and replan. Its interviews are cancelled and its panels released for others to use.

Add a student to a shortlist

Pick **Add student**, choose the company, type the student ID (for example **S0272**), add and replan. The company's CGPA cutoff is shown beside its name.

Remove a student from a shortlist

Pick **Drop student**, choose company and student, add and replan. That one interview is cancelled.

Two things worth knowing. A student below a company's CGPA cutoff is *refused with the reason*, never quietly scheduled — the cutoff is a rule, not a preference. And there is no "create a student": the student body is fixed by the university, so you add existing students to shortlists rather than inventing new ones.

8 Reading a proposal

The panel on the right, top to bottom. It answers one question: is this fix proportionate to the problem?

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
The headline sentence	Plain English: how many interviews must move, and whether that is within your limit.
The large number	Interviews moved, out of the total booked. The bar below shows it against your move limit; the marker is the limit itself.
"N more were cancelled by the disruption itself"	Cancellations you had no say in — a withdrawn student's interviews. These deliberately do <i>not</i> count against your limit.
A lower-churn fix exists	Two options side by side: one moves fewer interviews, the other leaves fewer unplaced. You choose which matters more.
Change lists	Grouped as moved / newly placed / cancelled to make room / cancelled by the event. Click to expand; hovering a row highlights that student on the board.
Who needs telling	One message per person, not per interview, marked NOW or FYI .

The buttons at the bottom

Apply this fix	Commits it. The board updates and a new version is recorded.
Apply the N-move fix	Appears only when a cheaper alternative was found — commits that one instead.
Discard	Throws the proposal away. Nothing changes.

If the fix is over your limit the button reads **Apply anyway** and the panel explains why. If no cheaper fix exists, it says so plainly rather than offering two near-identical options as though they were a choice.

9 Finding your way around the board

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Day tabs	Switch between days of the week.
Room filter	Narrow the board to a single room's column.
Company filter	Highlight one company and dim everything else, so the surroundings stay readable.
Click any interview	Traces that student across the day — everything else dims and a counter shows how many interviews they have. Click again, or press Esc , to clear.
Roomy / Compact	Compact fits more rooms on screen; roomy gives labels more space.
Theme	Light, dark, or follow your computer's setting.

10 The folded panels

Below the main workflow in the left rail. Click any heading to open it.

Priority overrides

When there is not room for everyone, the solver drops niche companies before mass recruiters. This panel overrules that: mark a company **Protect** to keep it ahead of the tier order, or **Drop first** to make it yield to everything else. Applies to the next build and the next replan.

At risk on Day N

Students with a full day, or with back-to-back interviews and no gap — the two things that make a delay cascade furthest. These are who to check first. Click one to trace them on the board.

What's changed this week

Every version of the schedule and every replan applied, with what caused it and what it cost. Each replan writes a *new* version rather than overwriting the last, so the plan that existed before a disruption is still there.

Can't be placed

Appears only when some interviews could not be scheduled. It names the companies worst affected and explains why — for example that there is more demand than there are rooms and hours, in which case no schedule could fit them all.

11 Who can do what

ACTION	COORDINATOR	VIEWER
View the board, metrics, diagnostics	Yes	Yes
Queue events and request a fix	Yes	Yes
Apply a fix	Yes	No
Build the schedule from scratch	Yes	No

Asking for a proposal changes nothing, so it is safe for anyone. Applying one moves real appointments in hundreds of people's days, so the permission sits exactly there. A viewer sees a **Read only** badge in the top bar.

12 Rebuilding from scratch

You will not normally need this — the week arrives already scheduled.

Build schedule in the top bar throws away the current plan and solves the week again from the beginning, applying any priority overrides you have set. It takes a few seconds. Use it after changing priority overrides, or to start clean.

This replaces the whole schedule. To fix something that has gone wrong, use the replan workflow instead — it keeps the existing plan and moves as little as possible.

